camaraderie within the high-security campsite and on the road showcased a warmth that transcended political boundaries.

Attending a public rally of around 50,000 in Nanded, I had the opportunity to meet Mallikarjun Kharge ji. On behalf of the NCP, we presented symbolic gifts, including idols of Maharashtra's Aradhya Daivat, Vitthal-Rakhumai and Ghongadi, a blanket made from a yarn of wool. Jayant Patil contributed by gifting Rahul Gandhi a photo of Rajiv Gandhi, reinforcing the unity among political allies.

However, the grandeur of the Yatra and its noble intentions stand in stark contrast to the grim reality facing Indian democracy, particularly in Maharashtra. The recurring issues of defections and government collapses threaten the foundational principles of democracy. The stability of a fairly elected government hangs precariously, undermining the very mandate for which our forefathers fought.

Instead of doubling farmers' income by 2022, as PM Narendra Modi had promised, farmers' concerns stand as a testament to the erosion of democratic values. The recent trade restrictions on agricultural products such as wheat, rice, onion and sugar, leading to significant cuts in agricultural exports, only add to the mounting challenges faced by the farming community and the nation. The intention to stifle constructive debate in Parliament becomes evident as Orwellian bills are rushed through in the eleventh hour, pulling at the delicate threads that hold the fabric of our democracy together.

The current state of the Indian Parliament, marked by the suspension of more than 140 Members of Parliament, reflects deep-seated structural issues within our democratic framework. This winter session has seen a Kafkaesque climax, unveiling a palpable fear within the ruling government —fear of dissent and the Opposition holding them accountable. Ironically, this fear exposes a profound anxiety about the basic tenets of democracy itself.

Apart from attacking democratic institutions, the current government excels at systematically weakening regional parties.[1] This involves